Michael Spaw

Senior UX Designer with expertise in designing **intuitive, data-driven workflows for 3D content creation** and digital tools. Experienced in **human-centered design, prototyping, and user research** to create seamless user experiences. Strong collaborator with engineering and product teams to translate user needs into impactful solutions.

CONTACT

587.577.2322
michael.spaw@gmail.com
LinkedIn.com/in/michaelspaw
Calgary, Alberta

EDUCATION

Industrial Design

University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS
Regents College, London, England
Centre College, Danville KY

SKILLS

UX/UI Design & Interaction Design
(Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture)

User Research & Usability Testing (Interviews, Contextual Inquiry, A/B Testing)

Data-Driven Design (Leveraging Analytics, Defining UX Metrics)

Human-Centered Design & Design Thinking

Facilitating UX Workshops & Cross-Functional Collaboration

Design System & Pattern Development (Maintaining UI Consistency)

3D Content Creation & DCC Tools (Maya, 3DS Max, Houdini, Blender)

Procedural & Workflow Design (Building efficient digital pipelines)

AI-Driven Tooling & Automation (Exploring AI-assisted design tools)

Additional Tools & Technologies

UX/UI Tools: Figma, Balsamiq, Qt Designer

Prototyping & Documentation: Miro, Mural

Agile Development & Collaboration: Jira, Confluence

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior UI/UX Designer

BRANCH 3D (STRUCTURECRAFT) / AUGUST 2025 – OCTOBER 2025

Contributed to the foundational UX and design system for a hybrid 2D/3D structural design platform integrating modeling, analysis, and digital workflows.

Evolved the platform's UI and interaction design to support intuitive geometry editing, technical visualization, and multi-dimensional collaboration.

Initiated 3D interaction patterns for navigating and editing complex structural models, emphasizing clarity, precision, and workflow efficiency.

Partnered with product, engineering, and project management teams to align early design decisions with long-term usability and system scalability goals.

Senior Product Designer/Product Owner
Media and Entertainment Division

AUTODESK / JULY 2015 – MARCH 2025

Designed intuitive 3D content creation workflows, improving usability for artists, game developers, and visualization professionals.

Developed the first cross-digital content creation functionality for Maya/Max, enhancing interoperability and efficiency.

Conducted user research & usability testing to refine AI-powered tools, integrating insights into product roadmap decisions.

Facilitated extensive beta and charter interactions to assess and maximize user value, ensuring designs aligned with customer needs.

Defined & maintained UX design patterns to drive consistency across Autodesk's content creation ecosystem.

Presented forward-thinking design concepts at Siggraph and Autodesk University, showcasing innovations in 3D content creation.

Collaborated cross-functionally with engineering & product teams, ensuring seamless implementation of design solutions.

Senior Designer

ELARA SYSTEMS INC./ JULY 2011 – JULY 2015

Designed & developed interactive 3D medical visualizations for education and training.
Created user-friendly animation workflows, reducing production time by 20%.
Conducted client research to improve content engagement & retention.

Additional prior roles:

3D Generalist ● Sauce LTD, Auckland, NZ
CG Supervisor ● Frantic Films, LA, CA & Vancouver, BC
CG Supervisor, Sequence Supervisor, Shot TD ● The Orphanage, San Francisco, CA
Senior Artist ● Stormfront Studios, San Rafael, CA
Artist ● Gametek, Sausalito, CA
Artist II / Product Design ● Anagram International, Minneapolis, MN
Artist on call ● Hallmark Cards, Kansas City, MO